BMW BREAKAWAY SESSION | Sustainable Mobility **New Ways Forward**



L-R: Rajesh Menon, Director General, Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers; Deepak Bagla, former MD & CEO, Invest India; Vikram Pawah, President, BMW India; Sudhendu Jyoti Sinha, Adviser, Infrastructure Connectivity (Transport), E-Mobility and Compliance Burden, NITI Aayog; Yogendra Pratap, Editor, *Auto Today*

FOR A GREEN TOMORROW

Sustainable mobility is the future, but India needs to address concerns like charging infrastructure and recycling of lithium-ion batteries, says a panel of experts

One of the toughest environmental and social challenges of our time is managing the mobility of people and goods. As countries across the world try to tackle this extremely important question, the need has also come to bring about mobility as sustainably as possible to protect the earth. Through the Union budget this year, the government has given a clear direction to a zero-carbon strategy for the economy. Experts at the BMW Breakaway Session at the India Today Conclave deliberated on new developments and challenges in clean mobility in India and how the adoption of green vehicles can be expedited. ■

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- It took India five years to sell the first million EVs. From October 2022 to February 2023, EV sales exceeded 100,000 every month
- Automotive sector constitutes 7% of India's GDP and 49% of manufacturing GDP
- To reduce the carbon footprint and the country's oil imports, the auto industry is adopting multiple pathways through EVs, bio fuels, ethanol blending, CNG and hydrogen
- The penetration of EVs is only 1% in cars, 4% in two-wheelers and 53% in three-wheelers